

The \$0 AI Starter Kit

5 free tools. 3 working automations.

Zero code. Ready today.

[*nocode-required.net*](https://nocode-required.net)

No email courses. No upsells. No 47-step frameworks.

Just tools that work and workflows you can copy.

Why this exists

Every AI article starts with "the landscape is changing" and ends with a CTA to buy a course.

This isn't that.

This is 5 tools I actually use, 3 automations I actually built, and the exact steps to set them up. No filler. No theory. If you can copy-paste a URL, you can do everything in this PDF.

Total cost: \$0/month.

Time to first automation: 15 minutes.

Code required: none.

TIP

Every tool listed here has a free tier that's genuinely useful - not a 14-day trial that locks you out after you've set everything up.

5 Free Tools (and What Each One Actually Does)

ChatGPT

chatgpt.com

Your AI assistant. Write emails, brainstorm ideas, summarize documents, draft social posts. The free tier (GPT-4o-mini) handles 90% of everyday tasks. Use it like a smart intern: give it context, ask for output, edit the result.

Why fr

Zapier

zapier.com

Connects your apps together. "When someone fills my form, send me a Slack message." That's a Zap. You build them by clicking boxes, not writing code. Free tier: 100 tasks/month - enough for most solo businesses.

Why fr

Make (formerly Integromat)

make.com

Like Zapier but more visual and more powerful. Free tier: 1,000 operations/month. I use Make when I need multi-step workflows with conditions and delays.

Why fr

Notion

notion.so

Your brain's external hard drive. Project management, notes, databases, wikis - all in one tool. Free for personal use. I use it for content calendars, client tracking, and meeting notes.

Why fr

Canva

canva.com

Design anything without being a designer. Social posts, presentations, PDFs, thumbnails. Drag and drop. Templates do the heavy lifting. Free tier includes 250,000+ templates.

Why fr

3 Working Automations (Copy-Paste Ready)

Each workflow below takes 15-30 minutes to set up. I've built every one of these and use them daily. Pick one. Build it today. Then come back for the next.

Workflow 1: Client Follow-Up Sequence (Make.com) (~25 min setup)

1. Sign up at make.com (free). Click "Create a new scenario."
2. Add trigger: Webhooks > Custom Webhook. Copy the URL it gives you.
3. Paste the webhook URL into your contact form (Typeform, Tally, Google Forms).
4. Add action: Flow Control > Sleep > set to 24 hours.
5. Add action: Email > connect Gmail/Outlook. Write a 2-line follow-up.
6. Add another Sleep (3 days) + another Email with a different message.
7. Add final Sleep (4 days) + final Email: last note, reply whenever.
8. Turn the scenario ON. Every new lead gets 3 follow-ups automatically.

TIP

Test it first: submit your own email through the form. Make sure all 3 emails arrive and the names are correct before going live.

Workflow 2: Social Media Backup (Zapier) (~15 min setup)

1. Sign up at zapier.com (free). Click "Create Zap."
2. Trigger: Instagram > New Post on Your Account.
3. Action: Google Sheets > Create Spreadsheet Row.
4. Map fields: Caption > A, Image URL > B, Date > C, Post URL > D.
5. Test with a recent post. Check your sheet.
6. Publish. Every new post gets logged automatically.

TIP

Why this matters: if Instagram suspends your account tomorrow, you have a backup of every caption, link, and date. Content archive - for free.

Workflow 3: New Subscriber Notification (Make.com) (~10 min setup)

1. In Make, create a new scenario.
2. Trigger: your email platform (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Buttdown) > New Subscriber.
3. Action: Telegram / Slack / Discord > Send Message.
4. Message template: "New subscriber: [email] - welcome them!"
5. Turn it on. You now know the second someone joins your list.

TIP

This makes growth feel real. Instead of checking analytics once a week, you get a ping every time someone signs up. It's motivating.

What to Do Next

1. Build one workflow today. Not three. One. Pick the one that solves your most annoying daily task.
2. Use it for a week. If it saves you time, great. If it doesn't, delete it and try another.
3. Come back to nocode-required.net for the next one. New posts every week - real tools, tested workflows, no jargon.
4. Use the AI Tool Advisor. Not sure which tool fits your workflow? Answer 3 questions, get a recommendation.
nocode-required.net/ai-tool-advisor.html
5. Start Here page. If you're completely new to AI tools, this is your entry point.
nocode-required.net/start-here/

nocode-required.net

Real tools. Tested workflows. No jargon.

Things you can actually use today.